

SnapStak.ai

VS Code Extension

Complete Setup Guide

From source code to installed extension

1. Prerequisites

Ensure the following are installed on your machine before starting.

1	Node.js v18 or higher Download from nodejs.org — npm is included
2	TypeScript Installed automatically via npm install
3	VS Code 1.85 or higher Download from code.visualstudio.com
4	vsce (VS Code Extension tool) Installed in Step 3 of this guide

Verify Node.js is installed by running: `node --version` in your terminal.

2. Project Structure

Your extension source files must be organised as follows before building.

```
snapstak-vscode/
├── src/
│   ├── extension.ts
│   ├── snapstakClient.ts
│   └── views/
│       ├── authViewProvider.ts
│       ├── workspacesViewProvider.ts
│       ├── settingsViewProvider.ts
│       └── zipViewProvider.ts
├── media/
│   ├── icon.png
│   └── snapstak-icon.svg
├── out/                               ← generated by compile
├── package.json
└── tsconfig.json
```

The out/ folder is created automatically during compile. Do not create it manually.

3. Install Dependencies

Open a terminal in the root of the snapstak-vscode folder and run the following commands in order.

Step 1: Install project dependencies

```
npm install
```

This installs TypeScript and all devDependencies listed in package.json.

Step 2: Install vsce globally

vsce is the official VS Code extension packaging tool.

```
npm install -g @vscode/vsce
```

The -g flag installs vsce globally so it is available from any folder on your machine.

4. Compile TypeScript

Compile the TypeScript source files in src/ into JavaScript in out/.

```
npm run compile
```

If the compile succeeds you will see no output and the terminal returns to the prompt. The out/ folder will now contain the compiled JavaScript files.

Common compile errors

- Cannot find module — check all import paths match your file names exactly (case-sensitive)
 - Property does not exist — ensure tsconfig.json targets ES2020 or higher
 - Type errors — check that @types/vscode and @types/node are installed
-

5. Package the Extension

Package the compiled extension into a .vsix file for installation into VS Code.

```
vsce package
```

This generates a file named snapstak-ai-1.0.0.vsix in the root of your project folder. The version number matches the version field in package.json.

If vsce warns about missing fields

vsce may warn about a missing repository or icon. These can be suppressed for local installs:

```
vsce package --allow-missing-repository
```

The .vsix file is a self-contained zip archive of your extension. You can distribute this file directly to any user on Windows, Mac, or Linux.

6. Install into VS Code

There are two ways to install the .vsix file into VS Code.

Method A: Command line (recommended)

```
code --install-extension snapstak-ai-1.0.0.vsix
```

VS Code will confirm: Extension 'snapstak.snapstak-ai' was successfully installed.

Method B: VS Code UI

1	Open VS Code
2	Open the Extensions panel Press Ctrl+Shift+X (Windows/Linux) or Cmd+Shift+X (Mac)
3	Click the three-dot menu Top right corner of the Extensions panel
4	Select Install from VSIX Navigate to your snapstak-ai-1.0.0.vsix file
5	Click Install VS Code will confirm installation and prompt to reload

After installation VS Code may ask you to Reload Window. Click Reload to activate the extension.

7. Verify Installation

After installation the SnapStak icon will appear in the VS Code Activity Bar on the left side.

1	Click the SnapStak icon in the Activity Bar The SnapStak sidebar opens
2	You will see four panels Account, Workspaces, Local Projects, Settings
3	Open the Settings panel Click Select Workspace Folder to configure your local folder
4	Open the Account panel Enter your SnapStak API key to connect your account
5	Open Local Projects Any .zip files in your workspace folder will appear here

8. Updating the Extension

When you make changes to the source code, follow this process to update the installed extension.

```
# 1. Compile updated source
npm run compile

# 2. Bump version in package.json if needed
#   "version": "1.0.1"

# 3. Repackage
vsce package

# 4. Reinstall
code --install-extension snapstak-ai-1.0.1.vsix
```

VS Code automatically replaces the previous version when you install a new .vsix with the same extension ID.

9. Uninstalling

```
code --uninstall-extension snapstak.snapstak-ai
```

Or via the Extensions panel: find SnapStak.ai, click the gear icon, and select Uninstall.

10. tsconfig.json Reference

Your tsconfig.json should contain the following minimum configuration.

```
{
  "compilerOptions": {
    "module": "commonjs",
    "target": "ES2020",
    "outDir": "./out",
    "rootDir": "./src",
    "strict": true,
    "esModuleInterop": true,
    "skipLibCheck": true,
    "lib": ["ES2020"]
  },
  "exclude": ["node_modules", ".vscode-test"]
}
```

SnapStak.ai — Deconstructing the Web